

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ Q T 6 5 3

♥ K 5 2

♦ Q T 2

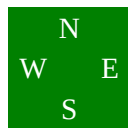
♣ 5 3

♠ A 9 7 4 2

♥ A 9 8 3

♦ K 6

♣ Q 7



♠ J

♥ Q 6 4

♦ A J 8 4 3

♣ T 9 8 4

♠ K 8

♥ J T 7

♦ 9 7 5

♣ A K J 6 2

West

North

East

South

Pass

1 ♠

Pass

2 ♣

Pass

2 ♥

Pass

3 ♦¹

All Pass

3NT

1. 4th suit

3NT by North

North opens 1 ♠ - how do you respond? With 14 points, you respond 2 ♣, a natural 2/1 force to game. North next bids 2 ♥, showing the other Major suit. What do you rebid now? You assume North to be 5-4 in the Majors, so you cannot support either. You cannot bid 2NT without a stopper in ♦ s. So you bid the fourth suit, 3 ♦, telling North you know you must make a bid, but can't find anything appropriate. This is an artificial bid, and normally denies a diamond stopper (otherwise you would have bid 2NT). North rebids 3NT - what do you do now?

North now must find a bid. His choices include rebidding the 5-card ♠ s, supporting South's ♣ s with a doubleton Queen, or bidding 3NT with the ♦ K 6 as a stopper. He chooses this last option. It appears that 3NT is the best game for these two hands.

Board 2

West Deals

N-S Vul

♠ K J 7 6 3
 ♥ A Q 7
 ♦ 8 4
 ♣ A Q J

♠ T 9 8 5 2

♥ 9 4 2

♦ T 5

♣ K T 6



♠ A 4

♥ K J T 8 6 5 3

♦ K Q

♣ 8 7

♠ Q

♥ -

♦ A J 9 7 6 3 2

♣ 9 5 4 3 2

West	North	East	South
1 ♠	Pass	2 ♥	Pass
3 ♥	Pass	3 ♠ ¹	Pass
4 ♣ ²	Pass	4NT	Pass
5 ♠ ³	Pass	6 ♥	

All Pass

1. control

2. control

3. 2 keycards + trump Q

6 ♥ by East

How do you open the bidding? With 18 HCP and a balanced hand, you open 1 ♠. Partner responds 2 ♥. What do you rebid? You know this is a 5-card suit, and bid 3 ♥, confirming the 8+card trump fit and sets the trump suit. Partner rebids 3 ♠, a control bid, showing first or second round control. (Some will play this as showing 3-card support for spades, but I recommend playing this as a control bid.). You bid 4C, also a control bid, showing first or second round control in clubs. Partner bids 4NT, a keycard request using 1430.

You bid 5 ♠, showing two keycards and the trump queen. Partner bids the slam. The slam is a good one. If either the ♠Q or ♣K is right there are 12 tricks by way of a finesse. But the best way to play the hand would be to try to establish a ♠ in the West hand, and if that fails try the ♣ finesse.

Board 3

East Deals

E-W Vul

♠ K 4
 ♥ Q 4 2
 ♦ J 8 7 5
 ♣ 8 6 5 2

♠ 8 6 3

♥ 7 3

♦ A Q 4

♣ A K J T 4

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 9 7 5 2

♥ J T 6

♦ T 3 2

♣ 9 3

♠ A J T

♥ A K 9 8 5

♦ K 9 6

♣ Q 7

West	North	East	South
		Pass	1♥
Pass	2♣	Pass	2NT
Pass	3NT	Pass	4NT
Pass	6NT		
All Pass			
6NT by South			

South opens 1♥ and North responds 2♣. Using standard bidding South would now jump to 3NT to show his 19 points, but in 2/1 this is not necessary since the partnership must not stop bidding until game is reached. So South just bids 2NT. North shows her minimum by bidding 3NT. South will now disclose his extra strength. He bids 4NT. This is not Blackwood, but rather a quantitative raise in Notrump, and an invitation to slam. North has 15 points, and they are good ones. She accepts the invitation and bids 6NT. There are 11 top tricks. A 3-3♥ split would provide the 12th winner, but this is against the odds. Better to try two ♠ finesses, a 75% chance.

Board 4

South Deals

Both Vul

♠ A J 8 7 5 2

♥ A K

♦ Q 6

♣ J 8 7

♠ K

♥ J T 9 5 2

♦ 7 5 3

♣ A T 5 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ Q 6 3

♥ Q 3

♦ A K J 9 4

♣ 9 6 4

♠ T 9 4

♥ 8 7 6 4

♦ T 8 2

♣ K Q 3

West opens 1♠ - You responds 2♦, natural and game forcing. West rebids 2♠. In our style of 2/1, this promises 6+ cards in spades, and denies a side 4-card suit. What should we bid now?

You should jump to 4♠. This is Fast Arrival, indicating a minimum hand with no particular interest in slam. West is happy to rest in the game contract. Even with a combined 30 points, 10 tricks are certainly not a sure thing. West must hope that South holds the trump King.

West	North	East	South
1♠	Pass	2♦	Pass
2♠	Pass	4♠	Pass
All Pass			
4♠ by West			